

Arkansas Baptist College

Strategic Plan

2025 - 2028



College Introduction Goals

Arkansas Baptist College was founded by the Colored Baptists of the State of Arkansas Annual Convention in 1884 as the Minister's Institute. Three months later, in November 1884, the school opened at Mount Zion Baptist Church in Little Rock Arkansas. In April 1885, the school was renamed Arkansas Baptist College.

The Arkansas Baptist College Strategic Plan for 2025-2028 includes the visions of a wide variety of participants. The resulting document outlines initiatives that aim to both strengthen and challenge the institution. The overriding goal of the plan is to make improvements at the College that will enhance the educational experience of the students who matriculate here.

Mission Statement. Arkansas Baptist College prepares students for a life of service grounded in academic scholarship, the liberal arts tradition, social responsibility, Christian Development, and preparation for employment in a global community.

Vision Statement. Arkansas Baptist College seeks to become a leader in Christian-based higher education where students are lifelong learners, seeking and building the Kingdom of God, engaged within their communities, and gain employment in industries that are changing the world.

Core Values. Arkansas Baptist College's Core Values are as follows:

- Mission Driven
- Historically Grounded
- Service Motivated
- Community Empowered
- Academically and Professionally Integrated
- Entrepreneurially Minded
- Fiscally Responsible

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| <i>Goal 1</i> | <i>Spiritual Vitality.</i> Promote a Christ-centered, Baptist worldview. |
| <i>Goal 2</i> | <i>Educational Excellence.</i> Demonstrate academic excellence in teaching and learning. |
| <i>Goal 3</i> | <i>Nurturing Environment.</i> Facilitate a supportive environment that is sensitive to the needs of students and all other constituents. |
| <i>Goal 4</i> | <i>Operational Efficiency.</i> Ensure efficient service and resource management. |
| <i>Goal 5</i> | <i>Resource Development.</i> Provide sufficient financial resources to support all aspects of the institution. |
| <i>Goal 6</i> | <i>Institutional Relations.</i> Enhance the reputation and relationships of the institution. |
| <i>Goal 7</i> | <i>Technology Leadership.</i> Maintain a technologically progressive campus. |

**Arkansas Baptist College Strategic Plan 2025-2028
Action Plan**

Table 1: Spiritual Vitality

Goal 1: Spiritual Vitality. Promote a Christ-centered, Christian worldview.

Initiative	Strategies	Responsibility	Outcomes/Assessment
1.1 Increase and strengthen the emphasis on outreach and service.	a. Integrate faith and learning activities with service-learning projects. b. Develop and implement strategies to promote curriculum-based service learning.	Office of the President, Academic Affairs	- At least 10% of students participate in two (2) or more service/outreach projects per year. - Students are equipped with skills for service when they leave ABC. - Student participation in service-learning projects by 20% (10% increments per year through 2028) FA2025 = 0 FA2026 = 10 FA2027 = 11 FA2028 = 12
	c. Develop and implement strategies to promote student-life-based service learning. d. Place visual aids on campus that remind students and employees of service (Christian Art).	Office of the President Student Affairs	
	e. Coordinate and facilitate service activities on campus through the Office of the President. f. Develop and implement strategies to promote community service for Arkansas Baptist College employees. g. Develop assessment measures to annually track and evaluate participation in service/outreach by employees and students.	Office of the President, Academic Affairs	
1.2 Increase spiritual formation building activities.	a. Increase the number of students attending weekly Chapel. b. Implement and facilitate campus-wide Bible study utilizing small groups. c. Identify and train small group leaders.	Office of the President, Academic Affairs, Student Affairs	- At least two hundred students participating on average in weekly Chapel by 2027 - At least 50% of graduating seniors indicate spiritual growth during matriculation at ABC. - At least fifty students participating in small group Bible studies by 2027.

Table 2: Educational Excellence**Goal 2: Educational Excellence:** Demonstrate *academic excellence in teaching and learning*.

Initiative	Strategies	Responsibility	Outcomes/Assessment
2.1 Establish partnerships in the areas of: • Instruction • Fundraising • Retention/Academic Advising • Community Relationships	a. Conduct workshops on collaborations b. Provide training in interdisciplinary instruction.	Office of the President, Academic Affairs	• Total enrollment increase of 5% annually • Total increase in graduation rate of 2.5% annually
	c. Identify resources to write grants for Academic needs. d. Develop guidelines for Academic department fundraising activities.	Office of the President, Academic Affairs,	
	e. Reevaluate Retention/Academic Advising System f. Implement an Early Alert System g. Develop plans to implement more mentorship opportunities for students. h. Increase opportunities for internships. i. Strengthen/expand service opportunities and relationships.	Advancement Office of the President, Academic Affairs, Student Affairs, Information Technology Retention	
2.2 Expand Academic Programs • Undergraduate • Graduate • Distance Education	a. Strengthening the academic program assessment process b. Expand library capacity. c. Seek approval from HLC to offer academic programs 100% online. d. Seek approval to offer Certificate Programs e. Seek approval to offer Graduate Programs	Office of the President, Academic Affairs, Library	• Computer Science Program Proposal approved by the Higher Learning Commission (HLC) • The Teacher Education Proposal approved by the Arkansas Department of Education, the Council for the Accreditation of Educator Preparation, and the Higher Learning Commission. • An increase of 3% annually in students in four-year degree programs. • The Higher Learning Commission approves all programs to be offered 100% online • The Higher Learning Commission approves the College's petition to add graduate programs.

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Initiative	Strategies	Responsibility Office	Outcomes/Assessment •																				
2.3 Strengthen student research emphasis and expand research infrastructure.	a. Expand student research opportunities. b. Develop and expand research infrastructure to support academic research.	Office of the President, Academic Affairs, Institutional Research	At least 5% increase in funded research by the end of the 2026-2027 academic year. • At least 5% increase in student-published research.																				
2.4 Increase graduate school and employment rates.	a. Using Clearinghouse data, track graduate school admittance rates. b. Using departmental records, track job placement rates. c. Hire a Career Services Coordinator d. Purchase tools to assist in job searches and host career fairs. e. Develop a recruitment strategy to recruit more students interested in research.	Office of the President, Academic Affairs, Retention Institutional Research	• Five percent annual increases in graduate school and employment rates are realized.																				
2.5 Maintain an adequate and qualified faculty.	a. Recruit well-qualified faculty b. Provide funding for faculty development. c. Identify and implement practices that support retention of qualified Faculty.	Office of the President, Academic Affairs	• At least 35% of the faculty have a terminal degree in their discipline.																				
2.6 Increase Enrollment	a. Recruit qualified students b. Provide student support with services necessary to foster student success. c. Seek funds to enhance scholarship offerings d. Track retention and make adjustments as necessary to increase the number of students retained through graduation/course completion. e. Purchase Jenzabar EX JRM to leverage technology and increase student engagement f. Create a partnership with the Common Black College Application (CBCA) and The Common Application g. Expand athletics programs. h. Meet Annual Enrollment Targets: <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Year</th><th>New</th><th>Actual</th><th>Projected Enrollment</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>FA2025</td><td>163</td><td></td><td>400</td></tr> <tr> <td>FA2026</td><td>171</td><td></td><td>473</td></tr> <tr> <td>FA2027</td><td>180</td><td></td><td>502</td></tr> <tr> <td>FA2028</td><td>189</td><td></td><td>533</td></tr> </tbody> </table> *Assumes a 5% increase year over year.	Year	New	Actual	Projected Enrollment	FA2025	163		400	FA2026	171		473	FA2027	180		502	FA2028	189		533	Office of the President Office of the President Admissions Advancement Retention Athletics	• Incoming first-time freshmen and transfer students increase at least 5% annually to attain a total enrollment of 533 or more new students by Fall 2028 (Baseline 523). • The College attains an average annual enrollment increase of at least 5%. • An incremental increase in the annual graduation rate of at least 2.5% • Term-to-Term Retention Rate of at-risk students increases by at least 2.5% annually.
Year	New	Actual	Projected Enrollment																				
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Initiative	Strategies	Responsibility	Outcomes/Assessment
2.7 Improve the overall registration process.	a. Enhance online options b. Improve collections.	Office of the President Office of the President Academic Affairs Student Affairs Business and Finance	Students express higher level of satisfaction with the registration process on the Student Satisfaction Survey.
2.8 Develop and implement a coherent, comprehensive co-curricular program.	a. Develop a rationale for a co-curricular program. b. Develop a plan for the co-curricular program. i. Provide a lecture series with notable speakers that address political, social, and cultural subjects currently being discussed. ii. Re-design chapels and assemblies iii. Provide seminars and workshops on life-skills, personal growth, and development, current events, and interdisciplinary conversations.	Academic Affairs Student Affairs	Students express higher levels of satisfaction in the Student Satisfaction Survey.
2.9 Increase emphasis on the mission of the College	a. Provide Strategic Plan Leadership i. Facilitate plan maintenance and objective achievement. b. Facilitate the Reaffirmation Process i. Provide administrative leadership and facilitate assignment completion	Office of the President	- Semi-annual reports demonstrate a well-managed plan with documentation of progress and accountability. - All preparatory work is done for a successful HLC visit. - Measurable increase in employee awareness of ABC's purpose - Established programs with measurable targeted outcomes in each area.

Table 3: Nurturing Environment

Goal 3: Nurturing *Environment. Facilitate a supportive environment that is sensitive to the needs of students and all other constituents.*

Initiative	Strategies	Responsibility	Outcomes/Assessment
3.1 Invest in repairs to current housing facilities.	a. Create a facilities committee. b. Create a list of repairs needed to Hill Hall, Ripley Hall, and 1600. c. Develop a budget and plan to make repairs. d. Update Ripley and Hill Halls to become Living and Learning Centers by Fall 2026	Office of the President Business and Finance Student Affairs	Repairs made to the dormitories no later than Fall 2026.
3.2 Improve support services for students.	a. Implement a tutoring center.	Office of the President Academic Affairs Retention	Implemented new Tutoring Center in January 2027.
3.3. Enhance student leadership skills.	a. Create a task force to develop student leadership opportunities and activities.	Academic Affairs Student Affairs Athletics	- Peer review process to be established in fall 2026. - Students possess the knowledge, skills, and sensitivities they need to become leaders of competence, conscience, and compassion (as evaluated by committee member surveys and focus groups)

Table 4: Operational Efficiency**Goal 4: Operational Efficiency. Ensure efficient service and resource management.**

Initiative	Strategies	Responsibility	Outcomes/Assessment
4.1. Develop a Quality Assessment Plan for Energy and Facilities	a. Develop and implement a comprehensive plan for energy assessment and management that addresses lighting and HVAC.	Office of the President Business and Finance	- A comprehensive plan for energy assessment and management is: - To Developed by 2026 to Begin implementation by 2027 - o Evaluated annually beginning June 2027.
4.2 Achieve budget management targets.	a. Implement revised planning and budgeting model. b. Provide the President and Executive Leadership Team with the necessary support to facilitate accomplishment of the College's strategic and financial goals.	Office of the President Business and Finance	- Achievement of annual and strategic financial goals. - Timely submission of the budget to the Board for review.
4.3 Develop and implement an Accounts Receivable Collections plan aimed at actually collecting 85% of tuition and fees	a. Develop Accounts Receivable Collections Plan b. Implement plan beginning with the 2026-2027 academic year.	Office of the President Business and Finance Financial Aid	- Plan developed by fall 2026 - Collections rate minimum is maintained at: - FY26 = 50% FY27 = 70% FY28 = 85%
4.4 Reactivate the Internal Audit function.	a. Hire an internal auditor to ensure compliance.	Office of the President	- Hire an Internal Auditor - Develop an Internal Audit Plan and Risk Management Plan
4.5 Review and revise the current Financial Stability Plan	a. Revise Financial Stability Plan to include activities and timeline. b. Complete institution-wide efficiency study for cost saving and operational efficiency. i. Identify cost-saving/efficiency measures ii. Develop a plan to implement measures.	Office of the President Business and Finance	- Measurable savings by June 2027 - Plan is implemented beginning August 2026 - Cost-saving/efficiency measures are identified.
4.6 Ensure compliance with Title IV Regulations and enhance Administrative Capability	a. Collaborate with the U.S. Department of Education to remove the College from HCM1 status. b. Implement best practices.	Office of the President Business and Finance Financial Aid	Reduced the number of audit findings by 90%

Table 5: Resource Development

Goal 5: Resource Development. Provide sufficient financial resources to support all aspects of the institution.

Initiative	Strategies	Responsibility	Outcomes/Assessment
5.1 Review, refine, and implement an integrated Development Plan	a. Evaluate and determine if conditions are appropriate for a Capital Campaign and/or a major special project. b. Develop identification of major prospects and solicitation tasks for major gifts. c. Develop a strategy to determine priorities.	Office of the President Advancement	Evaluation results implemented by Fall 2027
5.2 Implement a comprehensive plan for land development.	a. Develop a list of possible property (land) development projects and present it to the Board of Trustees b. Hire a consultant to develop a property development and make recommendations. c. Hire a staff person to serve as the industry lead person to build relationships with organizations (i.e., Blue Cross Blue Shield, Winthrop Rockefeller Foundation, etc.) d. Conduct public meetings to present land development plans for community feedback. e. Create a Land Development Committee. f. Create a Property Assessment Committee (PAC) (comprised of the Facilities Committee and Land Development Committee)	Office of the President Business and Finance	- Consultant hired by March 2027 - A consensus report from the community is received, signaling 'go-ahead' for start-up of designated projects. - Board-approved list is available by December 2026.
5.3 Generate revenue for the institution.	a. Achieve Capital Fund Raising Targets	Office of the President Advancement	- Achievement of annual fundraising goals beginning January 2026 - A self-sustaining student scholarship assistance plan is established by 2026. - First scholarships are disbursed in fall 2027.

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Table 6. Institutional Relations**Goal 6: Institutional Relations. Enhance the reputation and relationships of the institution.**

Initiative	Strategies	Responsibility	Outcomes/Assessment
6.1 Strengthen the link between ABC's Academic Programs and Little Rock Economic Development Programs and Workforce Training Needs	a. Create a committee that would develop a strategy to oversee developing and strengthening the College's relationships with industry, contracts, and community organizations. b. Conduct a study to identify current and future internship and job opportunities.	Office of the President Advancement	- Committee formed by June 2025 - The number of grants and Contracts generated will increase by at least 100% by June 2026. - Internships and job opportunities increase by at least 100% - Stronger public relations between ABC and the community are demonstrated by the post-survey results by June 2027.
6.2 Strengthen the relationship of the College with its alumni.	a. Create a committee to further develop existing partnerships between the Alumni Association and ABC a. Promote quality customer care.	Office of the President Advancement	- Committee created by 2026 - Online and written surveys demonstrate an improved relationship between the College and Alumni - Revenue from the Alumni Association and individual alumni increases by at least 20%.
6.3 Strengthen the quality of customer relations/customer service.	b. Increase customer service training that focuses on being initiative-taking rather than reactive and incorporates the key elements of responsibility. c. Develop a tracking system to evaluate customer satisfaction. d. Develop an institutional knowledge bank. i. Survey employees for expertise, gifts, and talents that can be shared campus wide. ii. Organize feedback in a brochure and/or an electronic format.	Office of the President	- Plan is developed by June 2025 - A measurable program for detecting, resolving, and improving customer service is created and implemented by June 2026. - At least one seminar/workshop in customer relations is provided annually beginning Fall 2026. - Customer satisfaction surveys demonstrate an annual 30% improvement in customer service. - A knowledge bank is available by December 2026.

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Initiative	Strategies	Responsibility	Outcomes/Assessment
6.4 Facilitate Institutional Enhancement	a. Develop a communication network plan. i. Develop a comprehensive communication/update program. ii. Develop a plan to provide links with faculty, staff, and students. b. Promote Board of Trustees development by providing: i. Training and Evaluation ii. A Board of Trustees Retreat	Office of the President	• Measurably increase stakeholder awareness of institutional developments • At least two training and evaluation sessions for Trustees to increase awareness and continuous self-improvement. • At least one Board Retreat provided to emphasize Board fellowship and strategic planning.

Table 7. Technology Leadership**Goal 7: Technology Leadership. Maintain a technologically progressive campus.**

Initiative	Strategies	Responsibility	Outcomes/Assessment
7.1 Improve campus communication systems.	a. Use web technologies to better communicate events & important dates. b. Make significant dates/events from departments on campus available from the ABC front page.	Advancement Information Technology	A more visible and An accessible web-based calendar that can be viewed from ABC's front page.
7.2 Provide technology training for faculty and staff.	a. Offer staff training in: i. Jenzabar EX ii. Microsoft Office	Information Technology	Offer at least two staff training opportunities annually.
7.3 Develop campus broadcast infrastructure for radio and television broadcasts.	a. Create a media center b. Provide A/V support campus widely. Purchase and install production, audio, and video automation equipment. d. Create a communications department to produce campus program content for broadcasting. e. Create an internet radio and television station.	Office of the President Information Technology	- Create a Media Center staffed and functional by December 2026. - Multi-media equipment will be supported by A/V technicians - Equipment will be purchased by 2026 to facilitate broadcasts. - Professionally produced programs available for broadcast to the public via the Internet by 2026.
7.4 Develop WiFi network infrastructure.	a. Install outdoor access points across campus at specific location(s) to be determined.	Information Technology	- Locations on campus for WiFi access points determined by December 2025. - Wireless devices were installed to provide WiFi internet services in May 2025.
7.5 Provide life safety and security system network infrastructure.	a. Collaborate with Public Safety to implement campus-wide life safety and security system.	Business and Finance Information Technology	Technology will install and support a campus-wide network. The system will be monitored by Public Safety by 2026.
7.6 Upgrade the campus email system.	a. Purchase and install Microsoft Office and Microsoft Exchange Server to update the campus email system and productivity suite.	Information Technology	Purchase, installation, and migration of the new system to be completed by August 2025.